

# ■■ Framing

## ■ What is it?

**The way information is presented shapes people's decisions and behaviours.**

We are influenced not only by *what* information is shared but also by *how* it's presented.

For example, saying “**80% lean**” sounds healthier and more appealing than “**Contains 20% fat**”—even though both mean the same thing.

## ■■ History

The concept of **Framing** was introduced in the 1980s by psychologists **Amos Tversky and Daniel Kahneman**, pioneers of behavioral economics.

They showed how different wording or contexts can completely change people's decisions, even when the facts stay the same.

## ■ The Psychology Behind It

- Framing works because people rely on **mental shortcuts (heuristics)** when making decisions.
- Positive framing (gains) makes something feel safer or more appealing.
- Negative framing (losses) highlights risks and urgency.
- The same fact, shown differently, can shift **perception, value, and behaviour**.

## ■■ Why It Matters

Framing can:

- Steer decision-making
- Shape how value is perceived
- Simplify complex options
- Downplay negatives if used carefully
- Cause confusion or mistrust if used poorly or misleadingly

## ■ How to Apply It

- **Positive framing** → “This product has a 90% success rate.”
- **Negative framing** → “Don’t miss out on this limited-time offer.”
- **Gain framing** → “Save \$100 with this purchase.”
- **Loss framing** → “You could lose out on exclusive benefits.”
- **Visual framing** → Use layout, colour, and icons to emphasize positives.
- **Task framing** → Ask questions in ways that guide insights and behaviour.

## ■ Theory in Action

- **Duolingo** uses playful animations that frame language learning as a fun, exciting journey instead of a chore.
- **Restaurants** place high-margin items in prominent spots on menus with eye-catching visuals to make them feel more appealing.

## ■ Final Thought

Framing is more than persuasion—it’s about perspective.

Well-framed options help users make decisions confidently and leave with a positive experience. The key is balance: present choices clearly, fairly, and in ways that create **mutual value** for both users and businesses.